

Behind The Word-Screen

You've doubtless noticed that of late, tech phrases, terms, and names float about freely, intermingled with regular speech. We know you know half those terms (or a little more, or a little less), and those that you do, there's a good chance you're not sure, or you "know" wrong, or you know half of what's to be known. If you deal with technology in any way—and you do, since you're reading *Digit*—you'd be happy knowing all those words that float around. That's our (simple) purpose here: to demystify everyday tech terms.

We'll extend that a bit and say that we're not just demystifying things; we're also explaining things where it is warranted. The following can be read cover to cover if you'd like, if you need a basic education of sorts, or it can be used as a reference for when you come across a new term—even, for example, in *Digit*.

We've covered pretty much everything you'd need to know in an everyday sense—the basic hardware of a computer, storage, peripherals (things like printers), the devices that deliver multimedia, portable gadgets, software, and network terminology.

We'd encourage you to flip through these pages even if you think you're familiar with most terms—for the reason that some of the terms we've covered go into somewhat in-depth explanations, which can be useful, and also because a term might not actually refer to what you think it does!

In the end, it's about being aware. So allow us to rip off the tagline of a popular technology site, modify it just a little bit, and state that as the *raison d'être* for this book: It feels good to know.